CORPORATE COMMUNITY GIVING IN A SHIFTING LANDSCAPE

A SAN FRANCISCO BAY AREA RESEARCH PROJECT

ASIAN AMERICAN VOICES FOUNDATION | BY CATHERINE TSANG

ASIAN AMERICAN VOICES FOUNDATION

“Strengthening San Francisco's grassroots AAPI-serving nonprofits through flexible funding, capacity building, and support.”

Founded in 2025, Asian American Voices (AAV) is a grassroots initiative developed in partnership with The Asian American Foundation (TAAF). Based in San Francisco, AAV provides capacity building grants and event sponsorships to local Asian American and Pacific Islander community-based nonprofits.

Asian American & Pacific Islander Heritage · ASIANS ARE STRONG. · Dear Community · COMMUNITIES AS ONE · ASIANS BELONG · REFUSE REFUSE · San Francisco Visitacion Valley Neighborhood Association SFVVNA · APAPA · FRIENDS OF INDONESIA · DELTA CHINATOWN INITIATIVE

THE CORPORATE OPPORTUNITY

$617.2B

U.S. charitable giving in 2025 (record high)

$43.7B

Corporate giving, about 7% of 2025 total

64%

Given by individuals, the largest source

Corporate community investment is a small share of total charitable giving in the United States, which means there is real room to grow.

How can nonprofits like AAV capture greater funding from corporations, and how has this effort shifted amidst the “shifting landscape”?

Source: Giving USA 2026, Indiana University Lilly Family School of Philanthrophy

DEI GIVING: A SHIFTING LANDSCAPE

2020
George Floyd's murder sparks national push towards DEI commitments; anti-Asian violence surges

2021
Stop AAPI Hate movement gains momentum; corporate and philanthrophic attention to AAPI causes grow

2023
Students for Fair Admissions v. Harvard strikes race-conscious admissions, signal to shift in DEI policy

2023-2024
AAPI groups establish stronger institutional infrastructure, yet funding remains stuck under 0.5% of overall corporate and foundation grant making

2025
Under Trump Administration, executive orders dismantling federal DEI programs cause many corporations to scale back on DEI



2026 - TODAY
DEI Giving landscape is mixed: larger companies remain disengaged, mid-tier companies slow re-engaging; rebrand towards "community investing" without DEI branding

MY OBJECTIVE

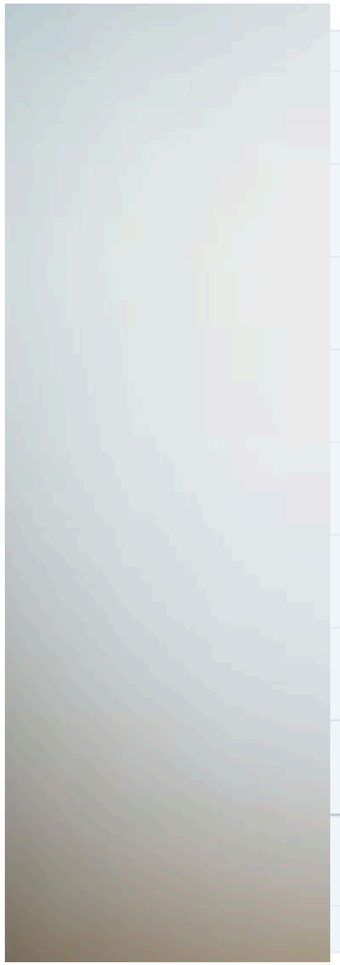
THE GOAL:

Has the DEI landscape changed the way corporations donate?

How can AAV and other nonprofits build stronger corporate partnerships?

WHY THIS MATTERS:

- Have an updated understanding of DEI changes to community-based giving
- AAV relies on fundraising to support the AAPI community—companies have the ability to make huge contributions



NYU Stern Student -- Project with Asian American Voices Foundation & Salesforce - Hi Rebecca, Hope you are doing well! Just wanted to follow up on ...

NYU Stern Student -- Project with Asian American Voices & Stanford - Hi Cindy, Hope you are doing well! Just wanted to follow up on my previous emai...

Asian American...

NYU Stern Student -- Project with Asian American Voices Foundation & The Giants - Hi Wilma, Hope you are doing well! Just wanted to follow up on my...

Asian American...

NYU Stern Student -- Project with Asian American Voices Foundation & - Hi Elaine, Hope you are doing well! Just wanted to follow up on my previous e...

Asian American...

NYU Stern Student -- Project with Asian American Voices Foundation & Blue Shield CA - Hi Kirsten, Hope you are doing well! Just wanted to follow up o...

Asian American...

NYU Stern Student -- Project with Asian American Voices Foundation & Ascend Global Leaders - Hi Mr. Furuyama, Hope you are doing well! Just wante...

Asian American...

NYU Stern Student -- Project with Asian American Voices Foundation & Lyft - Hi Christine, Hope you are doing well! Just wanted to follow up on my pre...

Asian American...

NYU Stern Student -- Project with Asian Ameri...

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NYU Stern Student -- Project with Asian Ameri...

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NYU Stern Student -- Project with Asian Ameri...

Asian American...

NYU Stern Student -- Project with Asian Ameri...

11	Levi Strauss	Yes	Yes			
12	Levi Strauss	Yes	Yes			
13	Pinterest	Yes	Yes			
14	Pinterest	Yes	Yes			
15	Pinterest	Yes	Yes			
16	Gilead Sciences	Yes	Yes			
17	Gilead Sciences	Yes	Yes			
18	Costco	Yes	Yes			
19	Costco	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	
20	Salesforce	Yes	Yes			
21	Salesforce	Yes		Email ...		
22	Clorox	Yes	Yes			
23	Clorox	Yes	Yes	Yes	Canno...	
24	Clorox	Yes	Yes		Canno...	
25	Blue Shield of CA	Yes	Yes			
26	Jay Paul	Yes	Yes	Yes	Canno...	
27	Uber	Yes	Yes			
28	Lyft	Yes	Yes			
29	Lululemon	LinkedIn	Yes			
30	Lululemon	Yes	Yes			
31	Gilead Sciences	Yes	Yes			
32	Gilead Sciences	Yes		Email ...		
33	LinkedIn	Yes				
34	Visa	Yes				
35	eBay	Yes				

Reached out to 30+ Bay Area companies with pitch deck, asking professionals to share their perspective

OUTREACH

BIGGEST CHALLENGE

Hi Catherine,

Thank you for reaching out. Unfortunately, we do not have a sufficiently detailed perspective on this topic to offer meaningful comments.

Best of luck with your project.

Unfortunately, we aren't able to participate, so we will have to decline your request.

Hello, Catherine,
I am unable to participate in your study.

Thank you for reaching out and sharing details about your research on DEI and corporate philanthropy. Your project sounds incredibly important, and I truly appreciate your interest in connecting.

Unfortunately I am unable to participate at this point.

INITIAL CHALLENGE

Response & Participation

ADAPTATIONS

Written question follow-up

Reached out to well connected mentor for introductions



PERSISTANCE & CONSISTENCY

QUESTIONS I ASKED

1. Over the past year or two, have you seen the language or framing around DEI-related giving shift? If so, how?

2. As the climate around DEI has changed, what have you observed about where corporate community dollars are going instead? Has funding moved toward different priorities, or largely stayed put under different names?

3. For a grassroots nonprofit serving a specific community, what makes for a strong partnership pitch in 2026, and has that changed from a few years ago?

OUTCOMES & OBSERVATIONS

25%
Response Rate

10%
Participation

5+
Industries

- Lack of response & participation: **POTENTIAL SIGNAL** for DEI public message
- Among respondees: Stated little change at local level, **SHIFT** in language
- When asked about DEI: Professionals answered about **“COMMUNITY IMPACT”**

CONVERSATION TAKEAWAYS

“[our giving] focus is often less on specific terminology and more on measurable community impact, employee engagement, and alignment with company values.” -Associate @ Investment Firm

“Our ERG budget is small...we like to support nonprofits by buying event tickets (like galas), and direct service nonprofits are easier to support.” -ERG Leader @ Fortune 500 Company

“Corporate funders are doing the same on their end: philanthropic priorities haven’t changed, but public-facing messaging has been scaled back.” -Nonprofit Development Executive

COMMON MESSAGE

- Local community giving in Bay Area has remained largely the same amidst DEI language shifts
- Employee Resource Groups (ERGs) decide donation dollars based on interest
- ERGs can better support nonprofits that provide a direct service or more tangible impact

AAV RECOMMENDATION & NEXT STEPS

- Companies often donate through event ticketing and require understanding of nonprofits' **DIRECT** mission

- AAV should host and attend more galas, event programming, and public fundraisers

- Potential recommendation: AAV Student Scholarship, demonstrates more tangible **SERVICE**

- **Project Next Steps: Conversation with Chief DEI Officer of Fortune 500 Company; share final giving strategies with AAV's 13+ partner organizations**

Case Study: JCYC Yearly Aloha Run



THANK YOU!